Indraprastha WORLD SCHOOL
Paschim Vihar, New Delhi-110063
Session: 2025-26

SAMPLE PAPER

English Language & Literature

Class: VIII **Maximum Marks: 80**
Time Allowed: 3 Hours

General Instructions

- This question paper consists of 9 questions.
- All the questions are compulsory.
- Attempt the paper neatly and legibly.
- Mention the serial number of the question attempted.

SECTION A (READING)

1. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow.

1. January 26 is celebrated as Republic Day in India. On this day in 1950, the Constitution of independent India came into effect, and the country became a democratic republic. The task of drafting the Constitution was undertaken by the Constituent Assembly, chaired by Dr. Rajendra Prasad, with Dr. B. R. Ambedkar leading the Drafting Committee. It took over two years to shape what became the longest written constitution in the world.
2. The Constituent Assembly had the challenging responsibility of laying down the foundational law of the land that would establish India as a truly democratic nation. Democracy is often defined as a system of government *of the people, by the people, and for the people*. The framers ensured that the Constitution reflected these ideals not just politically, but also in the social and economic spheres. As a result, the Directive Principles of State Policy were included in a special section of the Constitution.
3. These principles show that the Constitution's makers were fully aware of the deep inequalities and divisions within Indian society. They understood that political freedom alone was meaningless if a vast population remained stuck in poverty, ignorance, poor health, and outdated customs. Hence, the Constitution urged governments—both at the centre and state levels—to formulate policies aimed at providing equal opportunities and a decent standard of living to all citizens, regardless of gender, caste, religion, language, or region.
4. The Constitution refers to India as a 'Union of States' rather than a federation. Aware of India's diversity—linguistic, religious, regional, and social—the Constitution's architects designed a political structure where the central government holds significant authority, especially in legislative, administrative, and financial matters.
5. Most policies and programmes for India's social and economic development are initiated by the central government, while the implementation is carried out by the state governments. This structure was intended to create a unified national framework while still accommodating regional needs.

Based on your reading of the passage given above, answer the following questions:

A. Which of the following statements best describes the theme of the passage? 1
   a. The development of India's Constitution and its impact on democracy.
   b. The importance of cultural diversity in India.
   c. The economic policies of India.
   d. The role of agriculture in India's development.

B. Complete the given statement. 1
   The inclusion of Directive Principles in the Constitution shows that the Constitution makers wanted _____.

C. List two reasons why the Central Government was given more power than the states. 2

D. Do you think the Directive Principles are still relevant in present-day India? Justify your answer with reference to the goals of equality and justice mentioned in the passage. 2

E. Based on your understanding of the passage, choose the **INCORRECT** statement from the options given below. 1

a. Dr. Rajendra Prasad was the head of the Constituent Assembly.
b. India adopted a federal system giving equal power to both Centre and States.
c. The Constitution addresses inequalities among citizens through specific provisions.
d. The Constitution aims to secure a decent standard of living for all citizens.

F. Choose the option that correctly states the two meanings of **'foundational'** as used in the passage. 1

1. Basic
2. Decorative
3. Essential
4. Temporary
5. Structural

a. (2) and (4) b. (3) and (5) c. (1) and (3) d. (1) and (2)

G. The statement given below provides an Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Choose the correct option. 1

Assertion (A): The makers of the Constitution prioritized centralized power to maintain national unity.

Reason (R): India's linguistic and cultural diversity posed challenges to uniform development.

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

H. After which paragraph the following sentence best fit in the passage? 1

'This ensured that the Constitution would act not just as a legal document, but also as a moral compass for inclusive nation-building.'

2. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow.

1. Mankind's fascination with gold is as old as civilization itself. The ancient Egyptians held gold in high esteem. Gold had religious significance for them, and King Tutankhamen was buried in a solid gold coffin 3300 years ago. The wandering Israelites worshipped a golden calf, and the legendary King Midas asked that whatever he touched be turned into gold.
2. Not only is gold beautiful, but it is virtually indestructible. It will not rust or corrode. Gold coins and products fabricated from the metal have survived undamaged for centuries. Gold is extremely easy to work with. One ounce, which is about the size of a cube of sugar, can be beaten into a sheet nearly 100 square feet in size, and becomes so thin that light can pass through it. An ounce of gold can also be stretched into a wire 50 miles long. Gold conducts electricity better than any other substance except copper and silver, and it is particularly important in modern electronic industry.
3. People have always longed to possess gold. Unfortunately, this longing has also brought out the worst in human character. The Spanish conquerors robbed palaces, temples and graves and killed thousands of people in their ruthless search for gold. Even today, the economy of South Africa's gold mines depends largely on the employment of black labourers who are paid about 40 pounds a month, plus boarding and lodging. They work in conditions that can only be described as cruel. About 400 miners die in South Africa each year.
4. Much of the gold's value lies in its scarcity. Only about 80,000 tons have been mined in the history of the world. All of it can be stored in a vault 60 feet square, or a super tanker. Great Britain was the first country to adopt the gold standard, when the Master of the Mint, Sir Issac Newton, established a fixed price for gold in 1717. The discovery of gold in the last half of the nineteenth century in California, (1848) and later in Australia and South Africa changed everything. Before the discovery, there wasn't enough gold around for all the trading nations to link their currencies to the precious metal.
5. An out-of-work prospector named George Harrison launched South Africa into the gold age in 1886 when he discovered the metal in a farm near what is now Johannesburg. Harrison was given a 12 pounds reward by the farmer. He then disappeared and was eaten by a lion.
6. One of the biggest gold mining areas in the Soviet Union is the Kolyma River region, once infamous for its prison camp. The camp has gone, but in a way nothing has changed. Many ex-prisoners have stayed on to work in the mines and are supervised by ex-guards.

7. Despite the current rush to buy gold, 75 percent of the metal goes into making jewellery. Italy is the biggest consumer of gold for this purpose, and many Italian jewellers even tear up their wooden floors and burn them to recover the tiny flecks of gold. Historically, the desire to hoard gold at home has been primarily an occupation of the working and peasant classes, who have had no faith in paper money. George Bernard Shaw defended their instincts eloquently, 'You have to choose between trusting the natural stability of the honesty and intelligence of the members of the government,' he said 'and with due respect to these gentlemen, I advise to vote for gold.'

Based on your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below.

A. According to the passage, which of the following statements is **NOT** true? 1
   a. Gold is the best conductor of electricity.
   b. Apart from gold, copper and silver are good conductors of electricity.
   c. Gold can be easily beaten, hence it is easy to work with.
   d. Gold plays an important role in the modern electronics industry.

B. Complete the sentence appropriately. 1
   The wandering Israelites worshipped a golden calf _____.

C. Complete the following with the phrase from paragraph 1. 1

Opinion	Reason
	King Tutankhamen was buried in a solid gold coffin 3300 years ago.

D. Supply one point to justify the following. 1
   The desire to hoard gold at home has been primarily an occupation of the working and peasant classes.

E. Who launched South Africa into the gold age? 1
   a. Issac Newton b. George Harrison
   c. George Bernard Shaw d. A farmer

F. Select the option that corresponds to the following. 1
   The ancient Egyptians and the modern electronic industry both hold gold in high esteem.
   a. The hardworking student came first because of his diligent practice.
   b. Honesty is underrated whereas strategy is appreciated.
   c. The vibrant colours made the interiors look luminous.
   d. The steaming food was both appetizing and tasty.

G. Based on your reading of the text, list 2 reasons why the writer says that, 'Not only is gold beautiful but it is virtually indestructible.' 2

H. How were the black labourers exploited? Answer in around 40 words. 2

SECTION – B (WRITING AND GRAMMAR)

3. You are the Cultural Secretary of Lotus Public School, Delhi. Your school is holding a Debate Competition, 'War of Words' in the school. Draft a notice for your School Notice Board giving details of the programme. Sign yourself as, Ketan Mehta. **5**

4. You believe that all living beings have equal right to live on this Earth freely, and man has no right to enslave animals. You feel strongly when you see people being cruel to animals. Write an article on 'Cruelty to Animals' in about 150-200 words. You are Rajesh / Rajeshwari.

OR

You are Stuti Sharma, the secretary of the welfare organization of your school. Under your leadership, the organization was able to collect a substantial amount for the old age home, 'HELPME'. Express your sense of pride and happiness in the form of a diary entry. **5**

5. **Do as directed.**

A. Complete the sentence choosing the correct tense from the options. 1
   A solar cell is a device that _____.
   a. Converts light and produces electricity b. Converting light and produces electricity
   c. Converts light and produced electricity d. Converted light and produced electricity

B. Fill in the blanks with correct verbs of tense given in the bracket. 1
   The man waiting to take the test was very nervous. He _____ it before. (take)

C. Choose the correct tense used in the sentence below. 1
a. He spoke so well as if he knew everything.
b. He spoke so well as if he would knew everything.
c. He spoke so well as if he has knew everything.
d. He spoke so well as if he was knowing everything.

D. Fill in the blanks with the correct verbs of tenses in the sentence. 1
The river _____ its banks right now. (overflow)

E. Fill in the blanks with the correct modal verbs. 1
You _____ litter in a public place. (should not/ could not)

F. Fill in the blanks with the correct modal verbs. 1
Things _____ become sour anytime between them. (can/ shall)

G. Choose the correct use of modal verbs. 1
a. Rohit said to the stranger, 'Shall you lend me some money?'
b. Rohit said to the stranger, 'Could you lend me some money?'
c. Rohit said to the stranger, 'Might you lend me some money?'
d. Rohit said to the stranger, 'May you lend me some money?'

H. Identify the type of conditional sentence given below. 1
If I work hard, I will get good marks.

I. Complete the sentence with a suitable conditional type II. 1
If I won a medal, _____.

J. Complete the sentence with a suitable conditional type III.
1
If I _____him, I would have spoken to him. (see)

K. Choose the correct use of conditional sentence used below. 1
a. If she had bake the cake, she would have invited us.
b. If she baked the cake, she would have invited us.
c. If she had baked the cake, she would invited us.
d. If she had baked the cake, she would have invited us.

L. Change the following sentence into Passive voice, **'Do you teach Geography?'** 1

M. Change **'They always serve fresh food.'** into the passive voice. 1

N. Fill in the blanks with correct passive voice. 1
His latest novel _____ (publish) by a renowned company next spring.
a. published b. is published c. will be published d. was published

O. Change into passive voice, **'Read the book carefully.'** 1
a. The book is read carefully. b. Let the book be read carefully.
c. The book should be read carefully. d. Both b and c

SECTION C (LITERATURE)

6. Read the given extracts and answer the questions.

And I shall know what none shall know –
The silent kisses of the snow,
The Christmas candles' silver glow
Before I die.

A. What does the speaker mean by 'the silent kisses of the snow'? 1
B. How does the speaker show courage in these lines, even while talking about death? 2
C. Which of the following best describes the speaker's attitude in the lines above? 1
a. Nervous and fearful b. Calm and accepting
c. Excited and playful d. Lonely and confused
D. Identify the literary device used in the phrase 'the silent kisses of the snow.' 1

7. Read the given extracts and answer the questions.

She is not lame really; this is only her lame day. Nor are those others blind; it is only their blind day… In the course of the term, every child has one blind day, one lame day, one deaf day, and one dumb day. It is educative to both of them – the blind and the helpers.

A. What does the phrase 'it is educative to both of them – the blind and the helpers' suggest about Miss Beam's teaching method? 1

a. Only the helpers benefit by learning how to assist others.
b. Both students learn academic lessons through these activities.
c. Both the blindfolded child and the guide learn empathy and responsibility.
d. It is easier for the blind child than the helper to learn sympathy.

B. What is a 'blind day' in Miss Beam's school? 1

C. Why do you think Miss Beam gives each child a chance to experience different disabilities instead of just reading about them? 2

D. Find a word from the passage that means 'unable to walk properly due to injury or disability.' 1

8. **Answer any FIVE of the following questions in about 50- 60 words. 5×3 = 15**

A. How did the granddaughter show love and appreciation towards her grandmother?
B. Explain the theme of nostalgia in the poem, 'I Cannot Remember My Mother.'
C. Discuss the episode of Henry being terrified.
D. How does the poet's conversation with the apple blossom reveal the blossom's thoughts and attitude?
E. '… we make them share in misfortune too.' What does Miss Beam mean by this? Do you think Miss Beam was right in doing so?
F. Mii's father was healing, but the joy of healing didn't last long. Justify.

9. **Answer any TWO of the following questions in about 100- 120 words. 2×5= 10**

A. You are the narrator of the story, 'The School of Sympathy.' Write a letter to thank Miss Beam to allow you to spend a day in her school. Share with her your experience about her unique school system.
B. Imagine you are Mii's mother. After witnessing the terrible destruction caused by the atomic bomb in Hiroshima, write a diary entry describing your fear, sadness, and the pain of seeing your city and loved ones suffer. Share how the experience has affected you and your hopes for the future.
C. Analyze the character of the narrator in 'The Bewitched Jacket' based on his behaviour, decisions, and internal conflict. How does he change from the beginning to the end of the story, and what does this reveal about his values and personality?